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If You Are Retrofitting a Flowmeter, Send Pipe Photos Before the Quote

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Ruby L. | Velomac Flow Meter



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Many retrofit flowmeter inquiries begin with one short sentence:

“Please quote one meter for this line.”

I understand why that happens. The plant is busy. The pipe already exists. The team wants a fast answer. Procurement may want a quick number before the full discussion starts.

But retrofit flow measurement is where fast inquiries often create slow problems.

The real issue is that the drawing rarely tells the whole story.

What matters in retrofit work is not only the fluid and pipe size. It is the physical reality around the installation point.

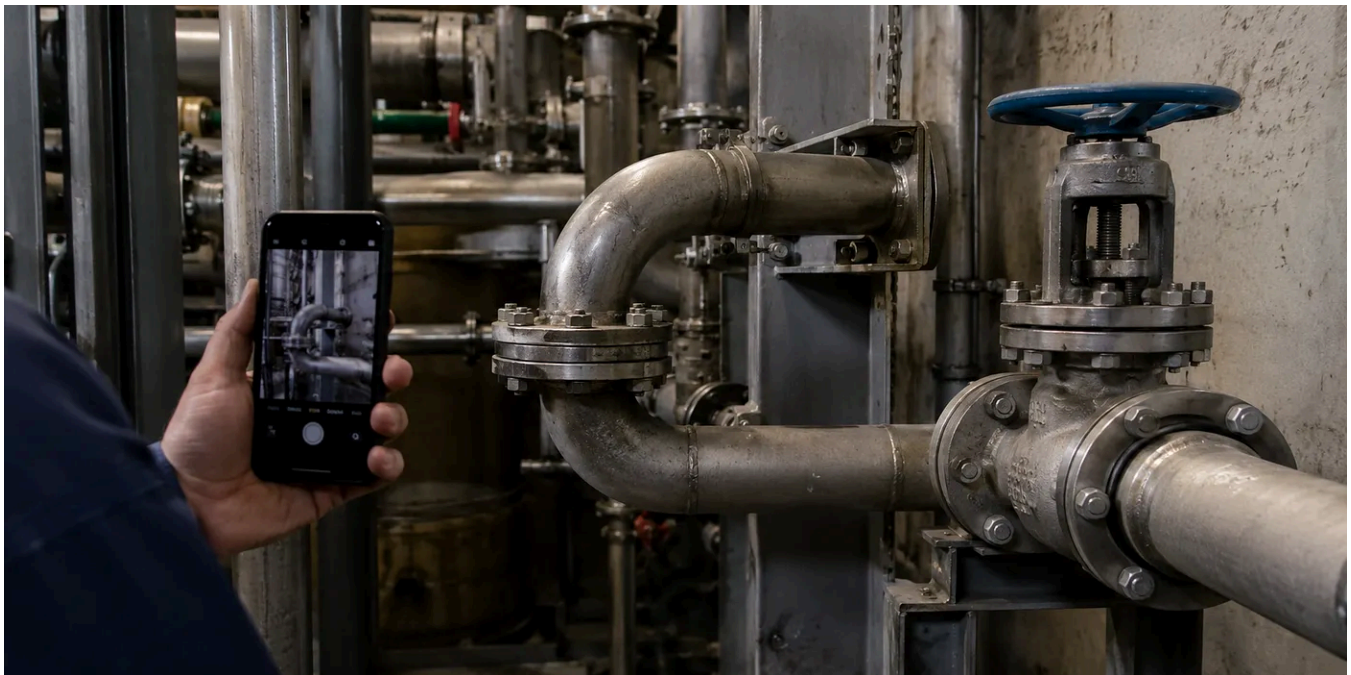
That is why I always prefer to see site photos early.

One clear pipe photo can reveal things that a short text inquiry usually misses:

- nearby elbows or valves,
- limited straight pipe,
- difficult access,

- vibration risk,
- shutdown constraints,
- display visibility,
- and whether cutting the pipe is realistic at all.

This matters because the correct technology is often shaped by the retrofit constraint.



Velomac Flowmeter

If the line cannot be cut easily, an ultrasonic path may become part of the evaluation for suitable applications. Velomac's ultrasonic range in the brochure includes clamp-on, wall-mounted, flanged, open channel, and thermal energy meter options.

If the space is tight and the straight run is limited, the discussion may move toward structures designed for those realities. Velomac's brochure presents V-Cone and balanced differential pressure flowmeters with minimal straight pipe integration advantages, which can be important in crowded pipework.

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If the process conditions point elsewhere, the answer may still be vortex, electromagnetic, turbine, thermal mass, or swirl. The point is not to force one technology.

The point is to let the site conditions decide.

Retrofitting a Flowmeter? Send Pipe Photos First



Site reality leads to better quotes.



ULTRASONIC
CLAMP-ON



V-CONE /
DP



VORTEX



ELECTROMAG



TURBINE



THERMAL
MASS

Velomac Flowmeter

I think a good retrofit inquiry should include five things before anyone tries to finalize the model:

- 1. The fluid and the real operating condition.*
- 2. Minimum, normal, and maximum flow if available.*
- 3. Pressure and temperature.*
- 4. Straight-pipe reality at the proposed location.*

5. *Photos that show the installation space honestly.*

After that, the rest of the conversation becomes more useful.

Can the pipe be cut?

What output does the system need?

Does the plant need 4–20 mA, pulse, RS485, HART, or Modbus depending on the product line?

How will maintenance access the meter later?

What calibration documentation is required?

Velomac's brochure emphasizes 100% in-house calibration, in-house R&D and support, and a broad product range because retrofit work needs more than a catalog answer. It needs a realistic match between the measurement principle and the site.

So if you are planning a retrofit, my advice is simple:

Do not hide the awkward parts of the pipe.

Show them early.

The sooner the supplier sees the real installation constraints, the sooner the quotation becomes honest, and honest quotations usually lead to better measurement.

If you want to know more, DM me ;)

Retrofit Flowmeter +

Flowmeter +

Instrumentation ✓

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Edit profile

Written by Ruby L. | Velomac Flow Meter

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Overseas executive at Velomac Flow Meter. Practical notes on flow measurement, selection, steam, gas, liquids and energy loss blind spots.
